INDIAN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT KOZHIKODE

Course Outline

Program Name	Bachelor of Management Studies
Course Code & Course Title	World and Indian History
Course type	Core
Pre-requisites (if any)	NIL
Course Credit	4
Total no. of sessions	30
Session Duration	2 Hours
Semester	III
Year and Batch	2026-27, BMS- 01
Sections (if any)	A & B
Instructor	Dr. Jayati Bhattacharya
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Office	
Consultation Hours	By appointment

Introduction

History is not only about what happened in the past; it is also about how societies remember, interpret, and draw meaning from that past. The ideas that shape our political institutions, economic systems, cultural practices, and collective identities have emerged through long and often contested historical processes. By placing India within wider historical processes, the course seeks to illuminate the connections, encounters and exchanges that have linked regions, communities, and civilizations across time and space, while drawing attention to distinctive experiences that have shaped particular historical trajectories.

Rather than treating history as a sequence of isolated events, the course approaches the past through a set of interconnected themes. Moving between local, regional, and global contexts, students will encounter diverse historical voices and perspectives, and consider how narratives about the past are created, preserved, challenged, and revised. In doing so, they will be encouraged to engage with history not merely as inherited knowledge, but as an ongoing conversation about human experience and its relevance to the contemporary world.

Learning Objective / Course Outcome

CLO No	**Course Learning Objective**	**Key Verb** From Bloom's Taxonomy verb list	**Linked PLO No**	**Key word linking CLO with PLO**	**Degree of emphasis given to the PLO in the course** Introduced / Emphasized / Reinforced	**Outcome measurement** Measured / Not measured
1.	Identify and describe theoretical framework, methods, sources and practices in History	Identify	1.1	Theoretical Framework	Introduced	Not measured

2.	Analyse people, experiences, encounters, and ideas rather than abstract processes alone in comprehending the past	Analyse				Not measured
3.	Use the language of interpretation, memory, evidence, and debate in written, verbal and creative forms of expression	Use	3.1	Language of Interpretation	Introduced	Not measured
4.	Analyse and connect historical understanding with contemporary organisational life without reducing history to a purely instrumental subject	Analyse	4.2	Contemporary Organisational life	Introduced	Not measured

Textbooks and Learning Materials (if any)

Text Books	**TB1** S. Bose and A. Jalal (2011). *Modern South Asia: History, Culture, Political Economy*. Routledge.
Reference Books	**RB1** E. Sreedharan (2004). *A Textbook of Historiography, 500 B.C- 2000A.D.* Orient Black Swan.
	RB2 David Cannadine ed. (2002). *What is History Now?* Palgrave Macmillan.
	RB3 Sugata Bose (2009). *A Hundred Horizons: The Indian Ocean in the Age of Global Empire*. Harvard University Press.
	RB4 S. Amrith (2011). *Migration and Diaspora in Modern Asia*. Cambridge University Press.
	RB5 A. Schottenhammer ed. (2019). *Early Global Interconnectivity across the Indian Ocean World I & II*. Palgrave Macmillan.
	RB6 T. Roy (2012). *India in the World Economy: From Antiquity to the Present*, Cambridge University Press

Readings (if any)

R1	E.J. Hobsbawm (1997). *On History*. Abacus.
R2	Matthew Lange (2013). *Comparative Historical Methods*. Sage.
R3	Thomas D. Hall ed. (2018). *Comparing Globalizations: Historical and World-Systems Approaches*. Springer.
R4	S. Bhattacharya ed. (2011). *Approaches to History: Essays in Indian Historiography*. ICHR-Primus
R5	William Bernstein (2008). *Splendid Exchange: How Trade Shaped the World*. Atlantic Books.
R6	Valerie Hansen (2012). *Silk Road: A New History*. Oxford University Press.

R7	D. C. Wong and G. Heldt eds. (2014). *China and Beyond in the Medieval Period: Cultural Crossings and Inter-Regional Connections*. Cambria Press, Manohar.
R8	T. N. Madan ed.(2004). *India's Religions: Perspectives from Sociology and History* (New Delhi: Oxford University Press.
R9	Pierre-Yves Manguin, et.al. Eds. (2011). *Early Interactions between South and Southeast Asia: Reflections on Cross-Cultural Exchange*. ISEAS; Manohar.
R10	Pedro Machado, S. Fee and G. Campbell eds. (2018). *Textile Trades, Consumer Cultures, and the Material Worlds of the Indian Ocean: An Ocean of Cloth*. Palgrave Macmillan.
R11	Toslima Khatun (2025). *Global Trade in the Early Medieval World: The Movement of Wealth Spice and Medicine, 700-1100*. Routledge.
R12	Satish Chandra ed. (1987). *The Indian Ocean Explorations in History, Commerce and Politics*. Sage.
R13	A. Clulow and T. Mostert eds. (2018). *The Dutch and English East India Companies: Diplomacy, Trade and Violence in Early Modern Asia*. Amsterdam University Press.
R14	Holden Furber (1976). *Rival Empires of Trade in the Orient, 1600- 1800*. University of Minnesota.
R15	Carl A. Trocki (1999). *Opium, Empire and the Global Political Economy: A Study of Asian Opium Trade, 1750-1950*. Routledge.
R16	Tan Tai Yong and Gyanesh Kudaisya (2000). *The Aftermath of Partition in South Asia*. Routledge.
R17	U. Butalia (2000). *The other side of silence: Voices from the Partition of India*. Duke University Press.
R18	Bill Schwarz (2017). *In History after Hobsbawm: Writing the Past for the Twenty-first Century*. Oxford University Press.

Technology & Software (if any)

	NA

Other Resources (Journals, Internet Websites) (if any)

OT1	E.J. Hobsbawm, 'The Social Functions of the Past: Some Questions', *Past & Present*, May, 1972, No. 55 (May, 1972), pp. 3-17
OT2	Charlotte Backerra, 'Source criticism for cultural history,' *Rethinking History*, 2024, 28:2, 194-216.
OT3	Tansen Sen, The Travel Records of Chinese Pilgrims Faxian, Xuanzang, and Yijing,' *Education About Asia*, 11:3, pp.23-33
OT4	M.S. Khan, "A Twelfth Century Arab Account of Indian Religions and Sects," *Arabica* , Jun., 1983, T. 30, Fasc. 2 (Jun., 1983), pp. 199-208
OT5	Jayati Bhattacharya, 'Old Routes, New Dreams: Reminiscences of the Southern Silk Road and Bengal China Connectivities.' *Journal of Economic and Social History of the Orient* Volume 64 (3), 18 May 2021, pp. 302-341.
OT6	H. P. Ray, "A 'Chinese' Pagoda at Nagapattanam on the Tamil Coast: Revisiting India's Early Maritime Networks," Occasional Publication 66, India International Centre, 2014.
OT7	K.N. Chaudhuri, The Unity and Disunity of Indian Ocean History from the Rise of Islam to 1750: The Outline of a Theory and Historical Discourse, *Journal of World History*, 4: 1, 1993, pp.1-21
OT8	Mansur al-Sharida, 'Merchants without Border: Qusman Traders in the Arabian Gulf and the Indian Ocean, c. 1850-1950,'*International Journal of Archaeology and Social Sciences in the Arabian Peninsula*, 17, 2023
OT9	H. V. Bowen, 'Bullion for Trade, War, and Debt-Relief: British Movements of Silver to, around, and from Asia, 1760-1833, *Modern Asian Studies*, 44:3 (2010), pp. 445-475.
OT10	Meera Kosambi and John E. Brush, 'Three Colonial Port Cities in India,' *Geographical Review*, 78: 1 (1988), pp. 32-47.
OT11	H.C. Aspengren (2014). "Indian Revolutionaries Abroad: Revisiting their Silent Moments," *Journal of Colonialism and Colonial History*, 15:3.
OT12	Claude Markovits, 'Indian Merchant Networks outside India in the Nineteenth and Twentieth Centuries: A Preliminary Survey, *Modern Asian Studies*, 33: 4 (1999) pp. 883-911.
OT13	T.A. Keenleyside, 'Nationalist Indian Attitudes Towards Asia: A Troublesome Legacy for Post-Independence Indian Foreign Policy,' *Pacific Affairs*, 55: 2 (1982), pp. 210-230.

OT14	Harsh V. Pant and Julie M. Super, 'India's 'non-alignment' conundrum: a twentieth-century policy in a changing world, *International Affairs* (Royal Institute of International Affairs, Vol. 91, No. 4 (July 2015), pp. 747-764.
OT15	Umesh Bagade, et.al., '"Subaltern Studies and the Transition in Indian History Writing," *Critical Philosophy of Race*, 11: 1, 2023, pp. 175-208.
OT16	Indrani Chatterjee, "Connected Histories and the Dream of Decolonial History," *South Asia: Journal of South Asian Studies*, 41: 1 (2018), pp. 69-86.

Pedagogy/Learning Process

Pedagogy: The course adopts an inquiry-based and discussion-oriented approach to the study of history. Lectures will provide the historical context for each theme, while seminars, source readings, case studies, maps, visual material, archival exercises, and group discussions will encourage students to engage critically with historical evidence and competing interpretations. Rather than viewing history as a fixed body of knowledge, students will be encouraged to examine how historical narratives are constructed, challenged, and revised in the light of new evidence and changing perspectives. Throughout the course, emphasis will be placed on connecting local, regional, and global histories and recognising the relevance of historical inquiry to contemporary institutions, societies, and organisations.

Learning Process and Objectives: By the end of the course, students should have developed a broad understanding of the major historical processes that have shaped India and the wider world. They will be able to engage with a range of historical sources and interpretations; and appreciate the interconnected nature of global and regional histories. Students will recognise history as a discipline that deepens their understanding of continuity and change, human agency, and the historical foundations of the contemporary world.

Evaluation Components/Assessment of Student Learning

Assessment Tool	Weight	Remarks	PLO Tested (give the PLO No)
Class Participation	10%	Class participation component will be graded on response and participation in class activities.	
Attendance	10%	Attendance will be considered an integral component of the course and will be assessed based on students' regular and punctual presence in class.	
Group Discussion & Short Assignments	20% (10+10)	Students will be given Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs), as well as short assignments (on using the archives/ case studies/ book reviews) that should display their comprehension, critical thinking skills and reflection based on the themes taught. Other details on assignments will be shared later.	
Mid-term Exam	25%	Exams will focus the knowledge building exercise and will be based on the shared course materials. Students should be able to comprehend, synthesis and apply their knowledge to address issues and debates raised by scholars in the discipline.	
Final Exam	35%		

Session Plan

Session No.	Module	Topic covered	Reading Material
1.		Why Study History? Relevance, Impact and Significance	**R1**, *On History*, pp. 32-48. **OT1,** 'The Social Functions of the Past,' pp. 3-17

2.	Understanding History as a Discipline	Historical Methods, Sources and Practices	**R2***, Comparative Historical Methods* pp.1-21. **OT2**, 'Source criticism for cultural history,'pp. 194-216.
3.		Global and Regional Histories: Scale, Perspective and Context	**R3**, *Comparing Globalizations*, Chapters 1 & 8.
4.		Indian Schools of Historical Thought	**RB1**. *A Textbook of Historiography*. Chapters 14, 15 & 16.
5.		Perspectives on Indian Historiography	**R4**, *Approaches to History*, pp. 56-86; 199-217.
6.	Positing India in Global History	India Through the Eyes of Foreign Travellers	**OT3,** "The Travel Records of Chinese Pilgrims," pp.23-33. **OT4**, "A Twelfth Century Arab Account," pp. 199-208.
7.		Commercial and Cultural Exchanges in the Ancient World: Baghdad to Canton	**R5***, Splendid Exchange.* Chapter 4, 'Baghdad-Canton Express,' pp.77-109.
8.		India and the Silk Route Connections I: Overland Networks of Travel and Exchange	**R6**. *Silk Road*. Chapter 5, pp.140-166. **OT5**, "Old Routes, New Dreams,' pp. 302-341.
9.		India and the Silk Route Connections II: Trade, Religion and Cultural Interactions	**R7**, "Buddhism and Maritime Crossings." Chapter 2, pp. 39-62.
10.		Religions in India: Encounters, Adaptations and Transregional Influences	**R8**. *India's Religions*. "Introduction," pp. 1-35. **R9**, *Early Interactions between South and Southeast Asia*, pp. 243- 262. **OT6**, "A 'Chinese' Pagoda at Nagapattanam on the Tamil Coast."
11.	Indian Ocean Networks	History of the Indian Ocean as a Connected Historical Space	**OT7**, "The Unity and Disunity of Indian Ocean History, pp.1-21. **RB6**, *India in the World Economy*. Chapter 4, 'The Indian Ocean Trade,' pp. 78 -122.
12.		Mariners, Merchants and Monks in the Indian Ocean	**RB5**, *Early Global Interconnectivity across the Indian Ocean World I*, pp. 191-224. **OT8**, "Merchants without Border."
13.		Connecting Europe and Asia: Textiles, Spices and Perfumes across the Indian Ocean	**R10**, *Textile Trades, Consumer Cultures*. pp. 289-311. **R11**, *Global Trade in the Early Medieval World*. Chapter 3, pp. 71-91.
14.		Islam and the Indian Ocean World	**RB5**, "Islam Across the Indian Ocean to 1500 CE." pp. 85-138.

15.		Shipping, Navigation and Maritime Mobility across the Indian Ocean	**RB5**, 'Shipping of the Indian Ocean World.' pp. 141-201. **R12**, "The Indian Ocean in the Nineteenth and Early Twentieth Centuries." pp.302-316.
16.	Mid-term Exams		
17.	Europeans in the Indian Sub-continent and Asia	European Expansion in South Asia from 17th Century CE.	**R13,** "The English and Dutch East India Companies." pp. 125-149. **RB6**, *India in the World Economy*. Chapter 7, pp. 181-209.
18.		Silver, Tea and Opium in the Imperial Expansion I: The bullion and the Tea	**OT9,** "Bullion for Trade, War, and Debt-Relief," pp. 445-475. **R14**, *Rival Empires of Trade in the Orient, 1600-1800*. Chapter 3, 'The triumph of Tea: The Making of British Power,' pp. 125-184.
19.		Silver, Tea and opium in the Imperial Expansion II: The China Trade and Global Connections	**R15,** *Opium, Empire and the Global Political Economy*. Chapter 5, "The most Gentlemanlike Speculation,' pp. 93-108.
20.		Interconnected Port Cities in Colonial Asia	**RB5**, In *Early Global Interconnectivity across the Indian Ocean World I*, pp. 343-374. **OT10**, 'Three Colonial Port Cities in India,' pp. 32-47.
21.		The Rise and Growth of Indian Nationalism	**TB1** *Modern South Asia*, Chapters 10, 13 and 15.
22.		Global Dimensions of Indian Anti-Colonial Movement	**OT11**, "Indian Revolutionaries Abroad."
23.		Indian Migration in the Twentieth Century: Imperial Strategies and Long-term Legacies	**RB4**, *Migration and Diaspora in Modern Asia*, Chapter 1, pp.18-56. **OT12**, "Indian Merchant Networks outside India," pp. 883-911.
24.	Post-Colonial Reconstruction and Nation-building	The Aftermath of the Partition of India: Memory, Migration and Reconstruction	**R16**, *The Aftermath of Partition in South Asia,* pp. 220-243. **R17**, *The other side of silence*. Chapters 2 & 4.
25.		Debates in Post-colonial India	**R18**, "Decolonisation as Tragedy?" pp. 96-118. **OT13**, "Nationalist Indian Attitudes Towards Asia," pp. 210-230.
26.		The Non-Aligned Movement: Aspirations, Achievements, Limitations	**OT14**, "India's 'non-alignment' conundrum," pp. 747-764.
27.		New Directions of Historical research	**OT15**, "Subaltern Studies and the Transition in Indian History Writing," pp. 175-208. **OT16**, "Connected Histories and the Dream of Decolonial History," pp. 69-86.
28.		Wrap up: How has History impacted management culture for different generations?	
29.		Group Discussions	
30.		Group Discussions	

Additional Instructions (If any)

Any other additional/ relevant sources will be shared on the Virtual Classroom page of the Course.